



**Brecksville-
Broadview Heights
City School District**

Special Education Audit Update & Preschool Models

Agenda

1. Special Education Audit Update
2. Preschool Model

Audit Recommendations

- Addressing the lack of confidence that special education staff and parent communities have in the current special education leadership.
 - Relationship building
 - PLCs
 - Coaching/being present
 - Attending meetings other than contentious ones

Audit Recommendations

- Recommendation of a serious review of a gap in the elementary schools' spectrum of services for students with disabilities (SWDs).
 - Creation of Autism Units
 - Addressing LRE
 - High percentage of students in Resource Room - elementary had over 65% in RR in 2020.
 - Below 50% on Resource Room now, with more students in class with their peers.
 - Behavior Intervention Specialist (considered ED Unit)

Audit Recommendations

- Central Office: recommendation of two coordinator positions reporting to the Pupil Services Director.
 - One hired in 2021 - MS/HS
 - One being hired for 2023-24 school year - Elementary

Audit Recommendations

- Paraprofessional aides: Recommendation was a reduction to proper levels of service to students that would result in the need for 20 fewer positions.
 - In 2020, Brecksville-Broadview Heights employed 64 educational aides (17.2 per 1000 students), the state average is 7.2 per 1000 students.
 - Recommendation was to employ 44 aides, a reduction of 20 positions resulting in a savings of \$790,000.
 - Currently employ 41
 - Process for [aide support](#)/independence plan

Audit Recommendations

- A Behavior Specialist appeared to be an area of need in district. It was recommended to address this.
 - Red Oak Health and Wellness
 - 2 Behavior Coaches at the elementary
 - 1 Behavior Coach at the M.S.
 - 1 Behavior Coach at the H.S.
- Additionally we hired a part-time BCBA
 - Her job is to study the behavior of students and create plans to improve or change problematic behaviors (FBAs/BIPs).
 - Also provides strategies/supports for teachers

Audit Recommendations

- Attention should be given to SWDs transition from PS to kindergarten, elementary to middle school and from middle to high school.
 - To avoid learning loss.
 - Have transition meetings with staff in May to discuss student strengths/needs.
 - Opportunities for SWD to visit buildings in Spring.

What have we accomplished?

- Provided professional development for building administration to ensure that each of the buildings has knowledgeable, qualified, and empowered administrators to oversee the provision of services for students.
 - Professional Learning Administrative Meetings
- Creation of Internal Monitoring Team
 - Consists of administrators, school psychologists, an SLP, and SPED PLC leaders
 - Meets monthly to work on compliance.
 - Tying ETR needs to IEP goal writing

What have we accomplished?

- Development of transition quality team
 - Working with SST to develop best transition practices/resources
 - During Open House at HS and MS had tables set up to meet CBDD (County Board of developmental Disabilities/OOD (Opportunities for Ohioans with Disabilities) staff
- Best practice protocols that help properly focus IEP-development and effectiveness during the IEP process.
 - Consistent expectations are communicated regarding the development of data-driven goals within IEPs and followed with professional development to support Intervention Specialists in more consistent and robust IEP writing.
 - All IEPs and Progress Reports are checked before being sent home.

What have we accomplished?

- In the area of mental health and behavioral well-being
 - Red Oak Health and Wellness for Behavior Support
 - Nancy Lowrie and Associates a Mindfully Company
 - Licensed therapists (insurance based)
 - One at each building
- Collaboration with ESC to review and refine Mental Health policies
 - HB123

What have we accomplished?

- High quality school districts have to have a “work together attitude.”
 - Working as a team - not Us VS Them attitude
 - Intervention Specialists asking for help
 - Continuous coaching
 - Daily presence in buildings
 - Continual professional development

What still needs to be done?

- Finish Special Education Procedure Manual
 - With all the changes that have been made, we want a true reflection of what we are doing.
 - Have created a 504 [Guidance Handbook](#)
- Building principals need to be empowered to be engaged directly with special education within their buildings.
 - This is a process. Through P.D., constant communication, and visibility in buildings we are getting there.

Preschool Models

General Education Classroom (2 sections AM & PM)

- A class taught by a general education teacher or dual licensed teacher with a maximum of eight children with disabilities and the class must be made up of 50 percent or fewer children with disabilities enrolled than children without disabilities.
- Special education services are provided through itinerant, direct or consultative, services.
- **Current: 8 Peers and 6 Special Education Students**

Preschool Models

Co-Taught Classroom (2 sections AM & PM)

- A class taught by two licensed teachers: one licensed general education teacher and one licensed intervention specialist
- Max of 8 children with disabilities

Current: 9 Peers and 8 special education students

Special Education Classroom (5 sections AM & PM)

- A class taught by a teacher licensed to teach preschool special education and at least 51 percent of the students are children with disabilities.

Current: 4 Peers and 8 special education students

Preschool Models

MH (Multi-handicapped classroom - 2 sections)

- All special education students

Current: Class 1: 8 students

Class 2: 7 students

Preschool Numbers

- Preschool numbers for 2022-2023
 - Total students: 113
 - Peers - 43
 - Special education students - 70
- Preschool numbers for 2023-2024
 - Number of students transitioning from P.S. to K (confirmed) - 51 (There are 3 families that have not decided yet)
 - As of 2/14/23 there are 58 confirmed students returning to preschool (37 have IEPs)

Preschool Numbers

- Preschool screenings for 2023-24:
 - 3 year olds: 15 students
 - 4 year olds: 21 students

This will impact the number of students from the previous slide.